



The U.S. Public Health Service Untreated Syphilis Study at Tuskegee

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About The Untreated Syphilis Study at Tuskegee

PURPOSE

- The 40-year Untreated Syphilis Study at Tuskegee ended in 1972 and resulted in drastic changes to standard research practices.
- Read on to learn about the impact of the study on the lives of those involved.



Background

The U.S. Public Health Service (USPHS) Untreated Syphilis Study at Tuskegee was a study conducted between 1932 and 1972. The study was supposed to observe the natural history of untreated syphilis. As part of the study, researchers did not collect informed consent from participants. They also did not offer treatment, even after it was easily available. The [study ended](#) in 1972 on the recommendation of an Ad Hoc Advisory Panel. The panel was convened by the Assistant Secretary for Health and Scientific Affairs, following publication of news articles about the study.

In 1997, President Clinton issued a [formal Presidential Apology](#). In his apology he announced an investment to establish what became [The National Center for Bioethics in Research and Health Care at Tuskegee University](#). Many records can be found in [the National Archives](#).

